

North Star Defense Card

Day 2 · Activity 2 handout. The card your quad locks its North Star into: the statement, a rebuttal to each of the three pitfalls, and a counter-metric that guards against gameability. Extended in Activity 3 with the CEO and dispatcher challenges.

Fill the template below. Keep each rebuttal under 30 words.

```
## North Star
We are winning when [outcome] increases for
[segment],
measured by [number].

## Pitfall rebuttals
- **Vanity:** Why does this number changing mean a
customer's life got better?
  > [your answer in <30 words]
- **Leading-indicator:** Could a team move this
without the customer being meaningfully better off?
  > [your answer]
- **Gameable:** What's the most cynical way a team
could hit this without earning it?
  > [your answer + the guardrail you'd add]

## Counter-metric (the guardrail)
A second metric that, if it moves *the wrong way*,
signals we're winning the NS
for the wrong reasons.
> [counter-metric]
```

What a counter-metric looks like

A counter-metric is concrete and paired with the NS, not a vague "we'd watch retention." For example:

- NS = "Hours of returned dispatcher time" → Counter = "% of dispatchers calling support after the new flow"
- NS = "Tickets resolved without escalation" → Counter = "Rate of repeated tickets from the same customer"

Activity 3 addendum — the CEO & Dispatcher test

After role-playing both personas, add the strongest challenge from each and how you'd address it.

CEO's strongest challenge:

How we'd address it:

Dispatcher's strongest challenge:

How we'd address it:
